“I’m Rose,” she said, stepping forward.

The German’s eyes locked on her. He turned and signaled to the soldier at his side. “Take her to the station.”

Virginie stepped in between them. “What for?”

The soldier grunted and pushed her aside with his hand. “None of your business.”

“Of course it’s my business. I’m a friend of her parents, and I’m responsible for her. I demand that you tell me what’s going on.”

“Her sister was arrested this evening for smuggling wine. We know she didn’t act alone.”

“Rose was here all night. You can’t just take her away without evidence.”

The two men looked at one another.

“It’s true,” Rose said. “I’ve been here all night. Paulette had a nightmare, and I heard her cry out. I went to her room, and she asked me to stay with her until she fell asleep.”

“Where is Paulette?” the soldier asked.

“My daughter is in her room sleeping, of course.” Virginie gave Rose a look of concern.

“I will ask her.” He looked at Rose. “You stay here.”

Virginie followed the soldier to Paulette’s room. Rose stood still, waiting, hopeful but anxious that Paulette wouldn’t let her down. When Virginie and the soldier returned, she held her breath, waiting for an answer.

“It’s true. The child said the young lady was with her through the night.” The soldier turned to Rose. “Who helped your sister bring all that wine to the river?”

She shook her head. “I don’t know. She doesn’t tell me anything.”

The soldier turned to Virginie. “And you?”

“No, all the wine making and selling is done by my husband—”

At that moment, the door opened and Weinführer Brucker entered. “Good morning.”

“Where’s my sister?” Rose stepped forward. “Is she at the town hall with Monsieur LeBlanc?”

“No. Your sister committed a serious crime in assisting Édouard LeBlanc to sell wine on the black market. I warned them both and they didn’t listen.”